SCAD
The University for Creative Careers

AI 201 Creative Computing with AI

Section: A01 CRN: 33702

FORTY5 259

Monday / Wednesday 2:00 PM - 4:30 PM

SCAD mission
SCAD prepares talented students for creative professions through engaged teaching and learning in a positively oriented university environment.

SCAD vision
SCAD will be globally recognized as the preeminent source of knowledge in the disciplines we teach.

SCAD values

Be Strategic. Research and measure to guide work and document results.

Be Innovative. Generate new ideas and relevant solutions.

Be Positive. Approach all endeavors with enthusiasm.

Be Collaborative. Embrace and act upon our collective genius.

Be Transformative. Create life-changing experiences.

Be Compassionate. Treat everyone with kindness and care.

Instructor Information

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Office Location
FORTY5 156
Office Hours: TH 11 - 1

Course Description

Students explore how to harness computing power for creativity, expression, and interactive design as they experiment with code, systems, and tools that bring intelligent behaviors to life. Prerequisite(s): AI 101.

Student Learning Outcomes

1. Exciting content coming soon!

Class Meeting Dates

1. Monday, March 23, 2026
2. Wednesday, March 25, 2026
3. Monday, March 30, 2026
4. Wednesday, April 1, 2026
5. Monday, April 6, 2026
6. Wednesday, April 8, 2026
7. Monday, April 13, 2026
8. Wednesday, April 15, 2026
9. Monday, April 20, 2026
10. Wednesday, April 22, 2026

11. Monday, April 27, 2026
12. Wednesday, April 29, 2026
13. Monday, May 4, 2026
14. Wednesday, May 6, 2026
15. Monday, May 11, 2026
16. Wednesday, May 13, 2026
17. Monday, May 18, 2026
18. Wednesday, May 20, 2026
19. Monday, May 25, 2026
20. Wednesday, May 27, 2026

Pre-quarter Assignment

Description
Pre-Quarter Assignment Log into a Chrome Browser with your SCAD email. This will unlock Gemini Pro for you. Navigat Then repeat this exercise with Claude at claude.ai. Give Claude the same syllabus, ask the san Create a GitHub account using either your SCAD email or a personal email: https://github.com/

Schedule of Classes

Class	Date	Meeting Information
1	3/23/26	Session 1 | Monday, March 23 Lecture: The Art Director's Engine. Why we use React to build interactive spa

Class	Date	Meeting Information
2	3/25/26	Session 2 | Wednesday, March 25 Lecture: Blueprinting the Vibe (The “Soft” PRD). Why AI needs strict creative
3	3/30/26	Session 3 | Monday, March 30 Lecture: Vibe Coding 101 - Directing the AI. Demo: Using Gemini to translate a
4	4/1/26	Session 4 | Wednesday, April 1 Lecture: The Cloud Save. Using Git to protect your art from bad AI decisions.
5	4/6/26	Session 5 | Monday, April 6 Lecture: The Director’s Cut (Fixing Hallucinations). Demo: Intentionally asking
6	4/8/26	Session 6 | Wednesday, April 8 Lecture: The Studio Crit. How to discuss interactive flow rather than just stati Apply: Live desk demos. Students present their Hero Screens and explain ho
7	4/13/26	Session 7 | Monday, April 13 Lecture: Tactile UI & Diegetic Design. Designing interfaces that feel like physi
8	4/15/26	Session 8 | Wednesday, April 15 Lecture: Forging the Toys (Prefabs & Props). Demo: Prompting AI to build an i
9	4/20/26	Session 9 | Monday, April 20 Lecture: Breathing Life into UI. Making the toys actually react to the player. De
10	4/22/26	Session 10 | Wednesday, April 22 Lecture: Faking the Lore. Demo: Having AI rapidly generate JSON arrays of fa
11	4/27/26	Session 11 | Monday, April 27 Lecture: The “Juice.” Demo: Tying animations, screen shakes, and color flash

Class	Date	Meeting Information
12	4/29/26	Session 12 | Wednesday, April 29 Lecture: Pitching the System. Demo: Studio Crit format: presenting working s STUDIO CRIT (P2): Crit prompt: “Show me one moment where you rejected w
13	5/4/26	Session 13 | Monday, May 4 Lecture: The Capstone Pitch & The Master Spec. This is your Design Intent fo Demo: How to write an airtight blueprint for a complete, multi-layered interact DESIGN INTENT (P3): The Master Spec is your formal Design Intent for the ca
14	5/6/26	Session 14 | Wednesday, May 6 Lecture: AI as Your Engineering Team. Demo: Feeding the Master Spec to Ge
15	5/11/26	Session 15 | Monday, May 11 Lecture: The Infinite Scroll (Mapping Data). Demo: Making the UI build itself b
16	5/13/26	Session 16 | Wednesday, May 13 Lecture: Deep Vibe Coding & Context Windows. Managing the AI so it doesn’ Demo: Context window management strategies. The student holds the high-v • PROCESS BLOG PROMPT: “What did you need to re-establish with A
17	5/18/26	Session 17 | Monday, May 18 Lecture: The Pocket Experience (Mobile-First). Demo: Having AI rewrite your
18	5/20/26	Session 18 | Wednesday, May 20 Lecture: Polishing the Artifact. Demo: Translating red console errors into plain
19	5/27/26	Session 19 | Wednesday, May 27 (Shifted from Memorial Day)

Class	Date	Meeting Information
		Lecture: The Final Polish. Demo: Auditing your Git history to prove your proce Apply: Students ensure their live pipelines are green, clean up their code, anc
20	5/29/26	Session 20 | Friday, May 29 (Shifted for Holiday Accommodation) Lecture: The Art Director's Post-Mortem. Demo: Studio Crit format: live demo STUDIO CRIT (P3) + POST-MORTEM: Final Design Cycle completion. Post-M

Grading Opportunities

#	Due Date	Assignment
20	4/8/26	Project 1: The "Hero Faction" Screen (20%) You are the Lead UI Designer for a new AAA game. Your first task is to design t The Vibe: This is an interactive poster. It needs to drip with atmosphere. When Deliverables: • A visually stunning, single-page interactive experience hosted live on t • Design Intent (Soft PRD) documenting your creative spec before AI eng • Mermaid diagram of your project flow: what receives input, how the sy • AI Direction Log: 3-5 entries documenting what you asked AI to do, wh • Records of Resistance: 3 documented moments where you rejected or • Five Questions reflection (short paragraph in README or sketchbook b Design Goal: Masterful typography, CSS Grid layouts, and atmospheric hover s
30	4/29/26	Project 2: The "Diegetic UI" Sandbox (30%)

#	Due Date	Assignment
		Great Game UI doesn't feel like a website; it feels like a physical object inside tl The Vibe: You will design three distinct "toys" or widgets. You aren't just drawir Choose three: • The Spellbook / Deck Builder: Cards that flip, highlight, and change sta • The Sci-Fi Inventory Terminal: A grid of items where clicking an object • The Visual Novel Dialogue Tree: A stylized text box that types out conv Deliverables: • Three working, interactive UI mechanics hosted live. • Design Intent for each toy. • AI Direction Log: 3-5 entries per project. • Records of Resistance: 3 documented moments. • Five Questions reflection before submission. Design Goal: "Juice" and micro-interactions. How does it feel to click your butto
40	5/29/26	Project 3: The Lore Codex (Capstone) (40%) For your final portfolio piece, you are building a complete "Companion App" or The Vibe: This is where you transition from Designer to Art Director. You will wr Pipeline Options Projects 1 and 2 use React as our shared classroom language. For the Capston React App (Default): The continuation of your P1/P2 stack. Build a polished, mo Unity: Build an interactive experience as a Unity project. Your Design Intent and Unreal (Plugin): Build a plugin or interactive tool within Unreal Engine. Same do Example directions:

#	Due Date	Assignment
		A Creature Bestiary: A searchable, filterable database of monsters with animat A TTRPG Character Generator: A tool that rolls stats and builds a custom chara A Tarot Card Reader: An app that draws random cards from a deck and display An Interactive Environment Tool: A Unity scene with procedural generation driv A Custom Editor Plugin: An Unreal plugin that extends the editor with AI-assiste Deliverables: A polished, mobile-responsive interactive tool driven by data, hosted live. Master Spec / Design Intent. Mermaid diagram of your full app architecture. AI Direction Log: 3-5 entries. Records of Resistance: 3 documented moments. Five Questions reflection before submission. Post-Mortem: A written reflection on your full Design Cycle for the capstone. Design Goal: A flawless, shipped product that looks spectacular on mobile and
10	5/29/26	Presentation and Professionalism (10%) Assessed across all three Studio Crits and your overall engagement with the De

Grading Standards

Letter Grade	Quality	Range	Undergraduate Quality Points	Graduate Quality Points
A	Excellent	90 - 100%	4	4
B	Good	80 - 89%	3	3

Letter Grade	Quality	Range	Undergraduate Quality Points	Graduate Quality Points
C	Satisfactory	70 - 79%	2	2
D	Poor	60 - 69%	1	0
F	Failing	0 - 59%	0	0

Required Materials

1. Core Software (Local Installations)

This is the software they must physically download and install on their MacBooks or lab computers.

- **Visual Studio Code** (VS Code): The primary code editor. This is our "Game Engine" workspace.
- **Node.js**: The runtime environment. This is strictly required so you can run **npm install** and **npm run dev** in the terminal to see their local browser previews.
- **Git**: The underlying version control software. (Macs usually have this pre-installed via Xcode command line tools, but Windows users will need Git Bash).

2. Required VS Code Plugins (Extensions)

You only need one required extension to make the vibe-coding magic happen inside the editor.

- **Gemini Code Assist**: This is the Google extension they will install directly inside VS Code. It provides the inline chat, code generation, and error debugging right next to their files.

3. Required Accounts & Logins

You will need to create or log into two specific platforms to participate in the class.

- **GitHub Account**: This is the most critical login. You need this to fork class Sandbox repositories, track their Git history, and automatically host their live web apps using GitHub Pages.
- **Google Account**: You will need a Google account to log into the Gemini Code Assist plugin in VS Code, and to access the Gemini web interface (for feeding it their long-form PRD documents during the planning phases). Note: Since we are using local VS Code instead of IDX, you use your SCAD.edu Google accounts.

4. Headphones or earbuds.
5. A Dedicated Sketchbook (Dotted Grid highly recommended): You cannot build a system you haven't drawn. You will be required to physically wireframe your Game UI concepts, component trees, and state

logic before writing your Product Requirements Documents (PRDs) or prompting the AI.

Do not store your project on an external drive. The portability problem is solved via GitHub and your external storage will break this.

Savannah and SCADnow classes - please visit https://www.bkstr.com/savannahstore/ and search for this course to view costs of associated texts and materials.

Atlanta classes - please visit https://www.bkstr.com/scadatlantastore/ and search for this course to view costs of associated texts and materials.

Recommended Materials

Required Materials

1. Your Textbook: AI

There is no traditional textbook for this course. Your primary learning resources are your AI collaborators. Claude (claude.ai and Claude CLI) and Gemini (via your SCAD Google account) serve as reference, tutor, and production partner. You will learn to direct them, evaluate their output, and build with them - and that process is the curriculum.

2. Core Software (Local Installations)

- Visual Studio Code (VS Code): The primary code editor. This is our “Game Engine” workspace.
- Node.js: The runtime environment. Required so you can run npm install and npm run dev in the terminal.
- Git: The underlying version control software. (Macs usually have this pre-installed via Xcode command line tools; Windows users will need Git Bash).

3. AI Tools

- Claude CLI: The instructor’s primary production pipeline. Command-line AI tool for agentic coding workflows. Install instructions provided in Session 1. Also available via claude.ai for chat-based interaction.
- Gemini Code Assist: The Google extension installed inside VS Code. Provides inline chat, code generation, and error debugging right next to your files. Available through your SCAD Google account.

React, Node.js, Claude, and Gemini are the tools we use in class demonstrations and shared exercises. The ESF framework is tool-agnostic: the same practices apply regardless of which AI you use. If you have a strong reason to work with a different AI tool or creative computing environment, discuss it with me in the first week.

4. Required Accounts & Logins

- GitHub Account: Required for forking class Sandbox repositories, tracking Git history, and hosting live web apps via GitHub Pages.
- Google Account: Required for Gemini Code Assist plugin in VS Code and the Gemini web interface. Use your SCAD.edu Google account.
- Claude Account: Required for access to claude.ai and Claude CLI. Free tier is available; Pro accounts are recommended for extended usage.

5. Headphones or earbuds.

1. A Dedicated Sketchbook (Dotted Grid highly recommended): You cannot build a system you haven't drawn. You will be required to physically wireframe your Game UI concepts, component trees, and state logic before writing your Product Requirements Documents (PRDs) or prompting the AI.

Extension: Connect the physical wireframe to a Mermaid diagram in the GitHub repository. The sketchbook establishes visual and conceptual intent; the Mermaid diagram maps system logic in a version-controlled format. Students produce a physical artifact (sketch), a programmatic artifact (Mermaid), and a built system. Deliverable for each project: "Mermaid diagram of your project flow: what receives input, how the system processes it, what it outputs." Important: Do not store your project on an external drive. The portability problem is solved via GitHub; external storage will break this.

Study (Field) Trips

Study Trip	Date	Description
1		TBD: Skill Shot Media visit hosted by Todd Harris. Data driven dynamic real

Extra Help Sessions

Extra Help Sessions	Date	Description
1	4/26/26	Virtual one on one help sessions. 45 minutes. Available to ever
2	5/24/26	Virtual one on one help sessions. 45 minutes. Available to ever

Extended Learning Opportunities

Extended learning opportunities are designed to enrich and expand students' course-based learning experiences. These university-wide extended learning opportunities (i.e., SCADamp workshops, SCADextra workshops, events and exhibitions, guided studio work, and virtual engagements) are offered both on-ground and virtually and allow students to further explore their discipline, discover new information, and deepen academic engagement.

Use the links below to view the schedule of upcoming events.

https://myevents.scad.edu/

https://app.scad.edu/workshops/

Information regarding extended learning opportunities specific to this course may also be communicated via Blackboard.

Suggested Extended Learning Opportunities

SCAD Libraries and Academic Resources

SCAD Libraries

Students at all SCAD locations can access SCAD Libraries' extensive collections, digital resources, and

research assistance both in person and online. Explore SCAD Libraries here: Millennium Web Catalog (scad.edu).

SCADextra Coaching: Academic Resources
SCADextra Coaching is your primary source for academic resources and support for students at all SCAD locations. Our services are free of charge and can be found in the Blackboard Assist portal at https://scad.blackboard.com/ultra/integration/bbAssist.

University Policies

Academic Integrity
Under all circumstances, students are expected to be honest in their dealings with faculty, administrative staff, and other students. For purposes of this policy, the term faculty or faculty member includes any person engaged by the university to act in a teaching capacity, regardless of the person's actual title. In speaking with members of the SCAD community, students must give an accurate representation of the facts at hand. Failure to do so is considered a breach of the Student Code of Conduct and may result in sanctions against the student, including suspension or dismissal.

In course assignments, students must submit work that fairly and accurately reflects their level of accomplishment. Any work that is not a product of the student's own efforts and is not original to the student is considered dishonest. Students must not engage in academic dishonesty; doing so can have serious consequences. Academic dishonesty includes, but is not limited to, the following:

1. Cheating, which includes, but is not limited to, a) the giving or receiving of any unauthorized assistance in producing assignments or taking quizzes, tests, or examinations; b) dependence on the aid of sources including technology beyond those authorized by the instructor in writing papers, preparing reports, solving problems, or carrying out other assignments; c) the acquisition, without permission, of tests or other academic material belonging to a member of the university faculty or staff; or d) the use of unauthorized assistance in the preparation of works of art.
2. Plagiarism, which includes, but is not limited to, the use, by paraphrase or direct quotation, of any published or unpublished work generated by any form of technology or another person without full and clear attribution of the source and authorized by the instructor. Plagiarism also includes the unacknowledged use of materials prepared by another person or agency engaged in the selling of term papers or other academic materials.
3. Submission of the same work in two or more courses without prior written approval of the professors of the courses involved.

4. Submission of any work not actually produced originally by the student submitting the work without full and clear written acknowledgment of the actual author or creator of the work.

To access the entire academic integrity policy and procedure, please visit SCAD / Compliance and policies / Academic integrity.

Attendance and Personal Conduct:
Students are expected to actively engage in courses to achieve the required learning outcomes. Absences in excess of 20% of the course (e.g., five absences for a 10-week course that meets twice per week) result in the student receiving a failing grade, unless the student withdraws from the course in accordance with the withdrawal policy. Absences due to late registration are included in the overall absences permitted for the course.

For **on-ground** courses, students are expected to attend and participate in all scheduled class sessions. Tardiness, early departure, or other time away from class in excess of 15 minutes per class session is considered an absence for that class session.

Students enrolled in **SCADnow** courses are required to check the online course site regularly and academically engage in the daily work of the course. Students earn attendance in SCADnow online courses through active participation in live class sessions and/or asynchronously by participating in academically related activities on a minimum of two separate days per unit/week.

To access the entire academic integrity policy and procedure, please visit SCAD / Compliance and policies / Attendance.

The student's appearance and conduct should be appropriate and should contribute to the academic and professional atmosphere of SCAD. The university reserves the right at its sole discretion to withdraw the privilege of enrollment from any student whose conduct is detrimental to the academic environment or to the well-being of other students, faculty or staff members, or to the university facilities.

Enrollment policies:
Students are responsible for assuring proper enrollment. See the SCAD catalog for information on add/drop, withdrawals, incompletes, and academic standing.

Midterm Conference(s):
Each student enrolled in the course will have a midterm conference scheduled outside of class time with the professor. Students are expected to keep this appointment.

Access and Accommodations:
Access and Accommodations through The Office of Disability Resources: SCAD is committed to

providing an accessible and inclusive environment for all students. Students with established academic accommodations under the ADA from the Office of Disability Resources are encouraged to provide their letter of approved accommodations to faculty in classes in which they are enrolled as soon as possible, as only students who provide the letter are eligible to use their accommodations. Students who have not yet established services through The Office of Disability Resources and have a documented disability may require academic accommodations are encouraged to contact The Office of Disability Resources as soon as possible since timely notice is needed to coordinate accommodations. The Office of Disability Resources staff will evaluate each request with required documentation, recommend reasonable accommodations, and prepare a letter of approved accommodations for students to provide to faculty dated in the current quarter in which the request is being made. Students are required to renew their accommodations each quarter through the SCAD Accommodate portal to receive their updated accommodations. Students may contact The Office of Disability Resources at disability@scad.edu or 912-525-6233.

Course Evaluations:
Course evaluations offer students a dedicated opportunity to provide constructive feedback on each of their courses. Student feedback gathered through course evaluations is essential to continuously improving the SCAD academic experience. Evaluations are available to students each quarter during Weeks 8, 9, and 10 through MySCAD. For additional information, contact evaluations@scad.edu.

Student Surveys:
SCAD strongly encourages students to provide feedback on their university experience through institutional surveys. The SCAD Student Survey and the Ruffalo Noel Levitz Student Satisfaction Inventory are administered to students across locations each spring. The National Survey of Student Engagement is administered biennially in winter. Following survey administration, SCAD's institutional effectiveness department analyzes and reports results to various SCAD departments to inform data-driven enhancements. For additional information, contact surveys@scad.edu.